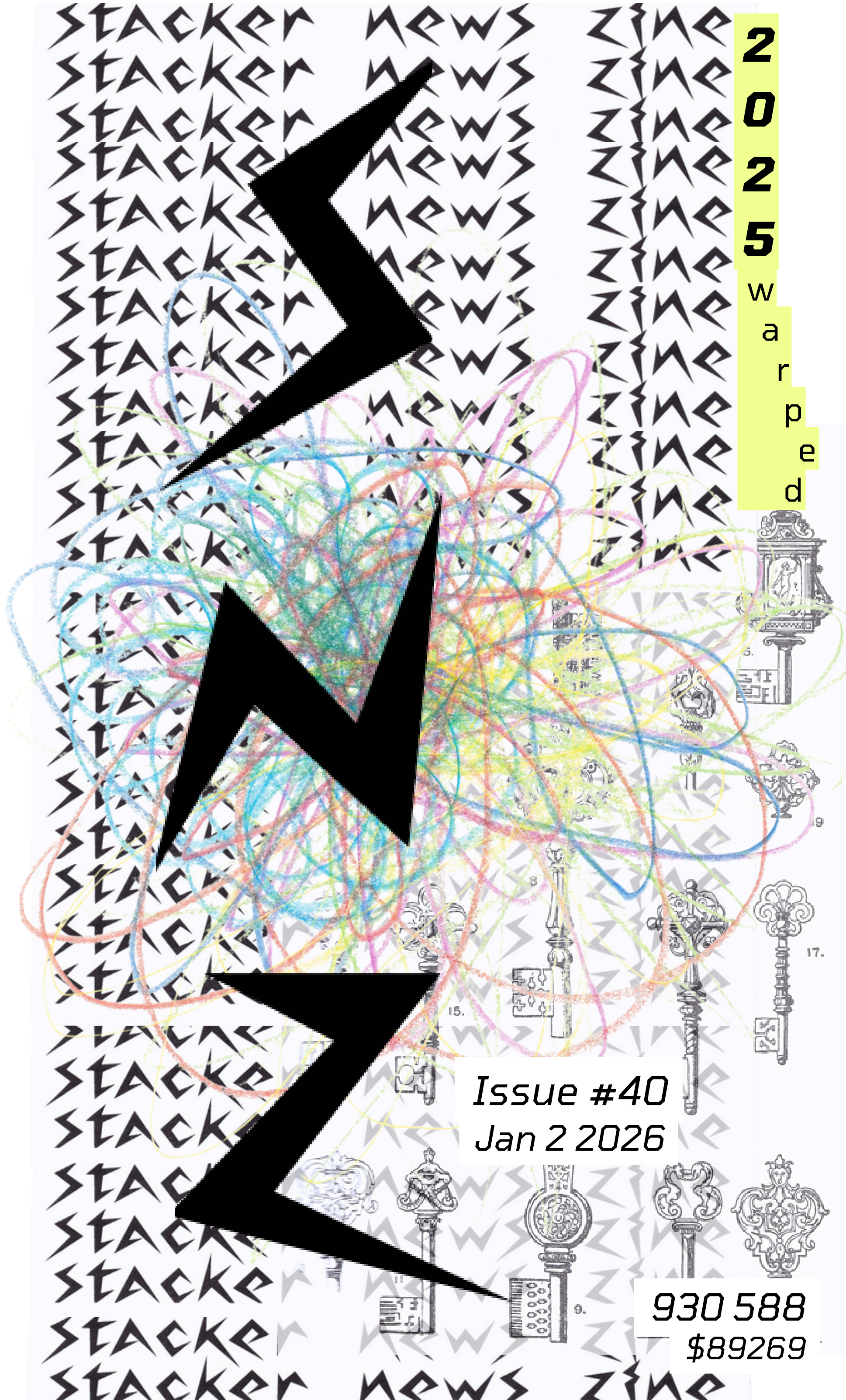

stacker news zine
SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS
Happy New Year Stackers
SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS


stacker news zine
SNZ
2025 warped
Issue #40
Jan 2 2026
930 588
$89269

contributors this year

aka cool people

huumn - 347 commits

ekzyis - 302 commits

soxasora - 92 commits

brymut - 18 commits

Scroogey-SN - 15 commits

ed-kung - 15 commits

pory-gone - 7 commits

riccardobl - 6 commits

abhiShandy - 5 commits

sutt - 4 commits

m0wer - 4 commits

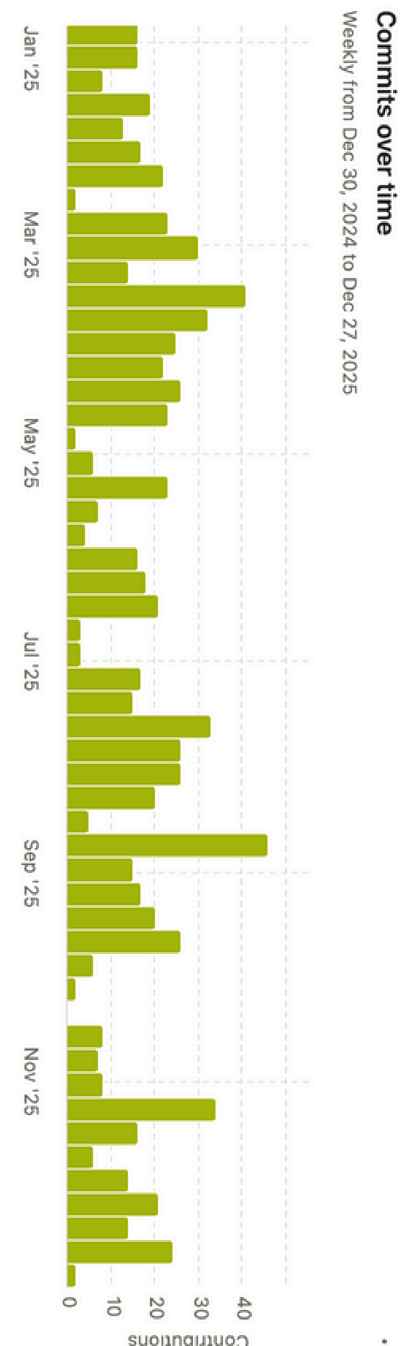
SouthKoreaLN - 3 commits

axelvyrn - 1 commit

secp512k2 - 1 commit

SuperAtic - 1 commit

jason-me - 1 commit



👏 *much appreciation* 👏

top posts by sats

Stacker News is curious about how bitcoin is changing the world.

Stacker News Takes Over TABCONF 7
348.7k sats \ 210k boost \ 90 comments \ @BlokchainB 13 Sep 2025 econ

Hi, it's Anita Posch! After 5 months in southern Africa AMA about adoption & BTC
199.6k sats \ 58 comments \ @anita 12 May 2025 AMA

Fear And Loathing On The Road To PubKey
106.1k sats \ 31 comments \ @siggy47 15 Nov 2025 the_stacker_muse

Impact of ongoing war on GrapheneOS development
104.1k sats \ 9 comments \ @final 18 Apr 2025 tech

What do people mean when they say Bitcoin bond?
102.7k sats \ 27 comments \ @Scoresby 17 Jun 2025 bitcoin

top stackers by items

you sats-crazed tech-obsessed lunatics just won't quit!

1. @247bf84fda
   33.2k items \ 1357 stacked \ 1298 spent
2. @grayruby
   17.5k items \ 4.4m stacked \ 5.5m spent
3. @Undisciplined
   17.4k items \ 4.2m stacked \ 5.5m spent
4. @BlokchainB
   10.7k items \ 2.3m stacked \ 8.9m spent
5. @Coinsreporter
   9834 items \ 1.1m stacked \ 650.4k spent
6. @SimpleStacker
   8568 items \ 1.3m stacked \ 412.7k spent
7. stacker is in hiding
8. @0xbitcoiner
   7462 items \ 992.5k stacked \ 391.2k spent
9. @k00b
   6995 items \ 13.9m stacked \ 6.2m spent
10. @denlillaapan
    6358 items \ 993.8k stacked \ 249k spent

Fooling yourself

3366 sats \ 17 comments \ @elvismercury 29 Dec 2025 mostly_harmless

top *post*

A modest proposal

People are blind to their own motivations if they don't work hard to discover them, and mostly even when they do.

The science behind this is overwhelming, perhaps illustrated best by split-brain patients confabulating their reasons for doing things [1]. (This video gives a more visceral demonstration, but only watch it if you're ready to be disturbed.)

Most people aren't brain damaged (insert joke here), but thinking of myself wrt podcasts, which I ostensibly listen to for information: digging into it and not allowing myself to lie, it's clear that most of my podcast-listening is motivated by self-soothing or other emotional regulation needs.

For instance, despite my periodic resolutions to the contrary, I listen to a stupid number of btc podcasts in order to be confirmed in the rightness of my own conclusions about btc; and to receive the Good News that btc will skyrocket in purchasing power. This makes me feel very smart, which I enjoy; and also gives me leave to imagine the cool things I'll be able to do when I'm rich, which I also enjoy [2].

At this point in my btc journey, it's quite rare for me to encounter a new idea or new way of thinking from one of these btc podcasts [3], which means that, according to my stated motivations, this is all wasted time. But of course my real motivations are not often my stated motivations. (The rest of my podcast diet appears more closely aligned to my stated motivations, but I'm probably lying to myself about these, too, although to a smaller degree.)

Anyway, this is a simple and harmless example, but the underlying point isn't harmless: it's hard to know why you're doing what you're doing, and you shouldn't have much faith in your default opinion on the matter.

Notes

[1] Gazzaniga, M. S. (2000). Cerebral specialization and interhemispheric communication: does the corpus callosum enable the human condition?. Brain, 123(7), 1293-1326.

[2] This isn't to say that my conclusions about btc are delusional -- I've spent so many hours wrestling with it that I have faith in my opinions. But that doesn't change my bullshit motivations for listening to the podcasts.

[3] Here's a fun exception.

I've routed an entire damn bitcoin

top post

2489 sats \ 44 comments \ @Undisciplined 31 Dec 2025 lightning

Probably quite a bit more, actually, but since Alby Hub started reporting these numbers a few months ago I've routed 101,937,368 satoshis.

That was over 6713 transactions and only cost the senders 14,973 sats.

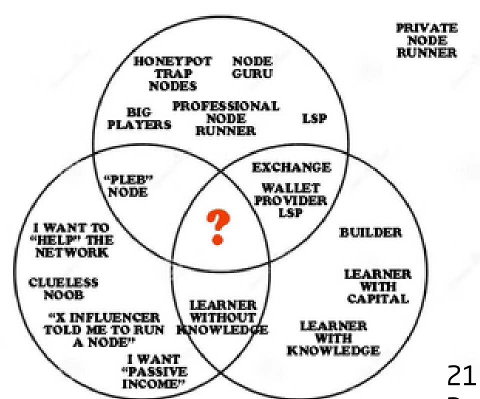
I'm still letting my fee structure evolve and suspect it's still pretty far from equilibrium. My sats per transaction are still increasing, as is my routing volume, and my channels are a little better balanced.

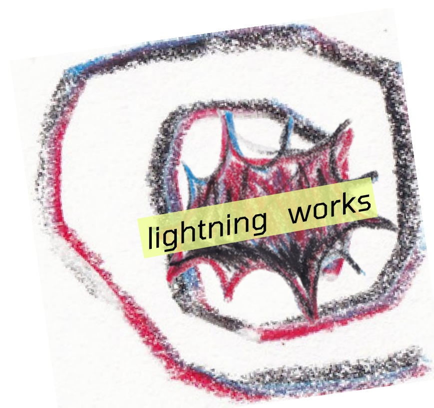
comments

69 sats \ 7 replies \ @WeAreAllSatoshi 31 Dec 2025
Very cool! How many channels do you have?

> 50 sats \ 6 replies \ @Undisciplined OP 31 Dec 2025
> Ten channels with about 13M total capacity.
>
> > 119 sats \ 5 replies \ @SimpleStacker 31 Dec 2025
> > Impressive. How many times have you had to manually rebalance / pay for inbound, if at all?
> >
> > > 50 sats \ 4 replies \ @Undisciplined OP 31 Dec 2025
> > > None. Despite the evidence so far, I believe prices can do the work of maintaining balance.

100 sats \ 1 reply \ @DarthCoin 1 Jan
Where do you see your node in 3 years?





> 21 sats \ 0 replies \ @Undisciplined OP 1 Jan
> Probably somewhere on the bottom right

An Interview with Sox

2542 sats \ 12 comments \ @plebpoet 2 Jan meta

Sox so good, we'll only ever need 1

I was lucky to share some Texas barbecue with @sox this summer - but I found I wanted to know more and more about this curious and interesting creature who has already added much to Stacker News. These are not extensive questions, and I ask you to add your own if you've got 'em.

What was the first impression you had about bitcoin?

"wait, I can now generate money with my computer?"
Mind you it was the 2011, the selling point to an 11 years old can be (is) free money. Of course it wasn't free, of course my parents got a huge electrical bill; of course I instantly fell head over heels for bitcoin.

Who is your hero and why?

My hero is no celebrity or popular person. It's a random guy I met on a Minecraft server when I was a child. They taught me that I can be a programmer, specifically how to use Java to create ***things***.

For a boy who used to be bullied by teachers for his school performance... because he just wanted to tinker with his computer, it was a completely new feeling to know that he can actually create things and be proud of them.
I owe a lot of what I am today to that random guy, he's one of my best friends.

What was your first impression of Stacker News?

It was one of those rare moments where you truly feel something's new is happening. It was (still is) bonkers to me that people were spending satoshis, *fractions of a penny for their thoughts* (🥁).

Robot/Human moderators felt a thing of the past, both for the fact that someone has to *put their money where their mouth is* (🥁) and that every stacker is actually a moderator thanks to ***downzaps***.
My first impression is actually disbelief, how could a concept this crazy even work? But it works.

Do you like to listen to anything while you're tinkering on the computer??

I like Electronic Dance. It's fun, creative and gives life back to digital music. My favorite piece of all time is Resonance by HOME, still gives me the chills to this day.

To be honest, it's hard for me to listen to something while trying really hard to stay focused and think about a problem that I'm trying to solve. But when I'm in the flow, and everything feels fine, music is there to make me fly through thousands of lines of code.

Thank you for your contributions here, I am enjoying new edit features rolling out, and I'm noticing subtle improvements to the look. Which part of the release stage is most fun for you? People seeing it? The initial build?

The funniest part, and I might be alone on this, is the post-release hotfixes. The post-release energy is no joke, especially when you're well aware of the creation you just published. We shipped over 30 bugfixes to the new editor in just a week!

People seeing it, instead, is one of the most anxious moments I can endure. But also the most exciting, this is where your creation finally shows what it's capable of.
oh and thank you guys!

thanks Sox!

Meme Monday - Top Meme Goes in the Newsletter

198 sats \ 4 comments \ @sn 29 Dec 2025 memes

From Airline Pilot to Bitcoiner - My Story

16.2k sats \ 10 comments \ @anon 30 Dec 2025 bitcoin

top post

I had been waiting to tell 'my story' for a while now... but when you start talking about 'work' on a public forum (even a 'niche' one like Stacker News) I think it's a good idea to be discreet. My 'avenue' to Bitcoin was totally, utterly non-traditional and in fact I wouldn't have "got into" Bitcoin were it not for aviation. I wouldn't 'understand' it today... I just see so many "bad takes" on Bitcoin that are near-worthless... I wouldn't understand Bitcoin if it weren't for 1) having a strong background in Aviation and 2) being a minority (based on religion/sex/race/gender etc it doesn't matter the specific category it's all the same...)

Those 2 things - Energy and Personal Property Rights/Network Rights/Network Access for anyone brave enough regardless of color or creed changed my life. So let me start near the beginning.

I didn't go to university for Aviation but for "Liberal Arts" (LOL) and after using my liberal arts degree for a few years... I realized I wanted something different. My father had been a pilot in the Air Force, had always flown first for the government then for the "private sector..." and it was something I had been long-term interested in.

I decided to go to 'aviation school' in the 2010s and the program I went to was intense. The expectation was that you would study and fly (with an instructor if you weren't 'soloing') every day as the design of the program was "drinking from a fire-hose." A program like that is designed to either make you succeed or make you quit. Flying every day in a Cessna is really, really tiring because as a 'beginner pilot' you are

simply overwhelmed. Physically flying the airplane, communicating on the radios, understanding what and when and then executing what you are doing "time-compressed" is something that has little parallel with most other jobs in my opinion. Beginner pilots are easily overwhelmed (because they are beginners) and I was too... but if you studied enough they would keep "throwing you in the pool" and pushing you and you learned, A LOT.

I eventually earned "all my ratings" (single engine, multi-engine, instrument, instructor etc) but career-wise you don't have a lot of experience. Most 'new pilots' have around 250 hours and in the United States all you can do early in your career is teach in light aircraft (Cessna, Pipers etc) which I did.

continued

I always looked for an 'advantage' and the opportunity to learn more, to understand how airplanes worked, how to be a better instructor and most importantly how to be safer. Teaching people 'how to fly' in small airplanes hour after hour day after day... in truth is really dangerous. Your students are unintentionally trying to kill you every day... I had a few flight-instructor friends or friends of friends who were killed over the years it's serious business and most CFIs (certified flight instructors) have the same or similar experience.

My favorite 'flying' book was (and is!) called Aerodynamics for Naval Aviators originally published by the United States Navy in the 1960s. Its purpose was (as relevant then as now) to teach Energy Management to Naval Aviators flying at a high AoA (Angle of Attack) basically low and slow while trying to land on an aircraft carrier. Taking off heavy with fuel and ordnance, completing your 'mission' then returning to the carrier to land after a long-ass-day flying is no joke... and in the 1960s a lot of Navy pilots were unfortunately killed trying to land on a big boat.

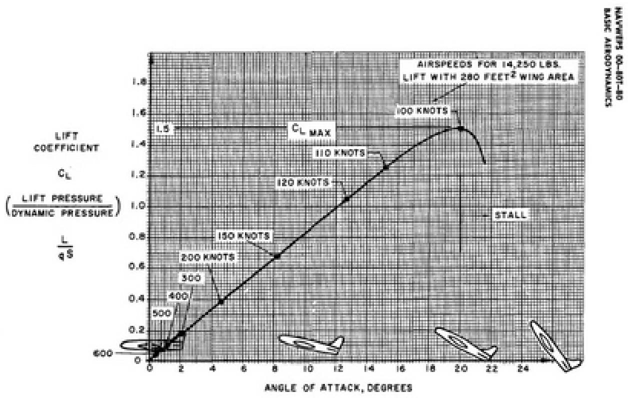


Figure 1.11. Typical Lift Characteristics

I remember spending hour after hour, long after I had finished 'teaching' for the day pouring over this book... it was (and is) everything that you wanted to know about aerodynamics as a pilot but were afraid to ask. To summarize a very long text, and many concepts, is to say that there is no free lunch in engineering, you can convert one form of energy to another but energy is NOT free.

Airspeed can be converted to altitude, or altitude converted to airspeed with varying levels of efficiency - you can convert one to another depending on terrain, weather, endurance, range, conditions of flight, configuration etc...

But energy is never FREE and eventually you will run out! Good engineering (and good aviation) is all about profile and risk management and how you can store and transfer energy across your equipment depending on procedure, training and performance guidelines.

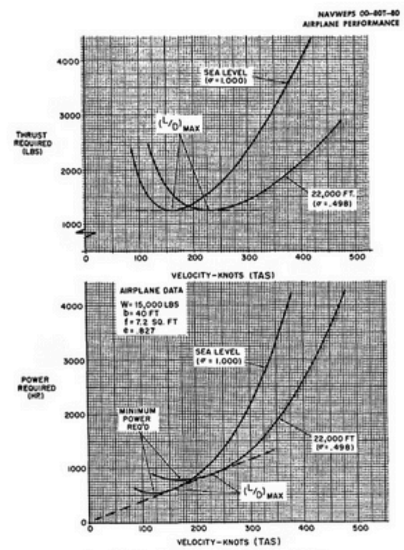


Figure 2.4. Effect of Altitude on Thrust and Power Required

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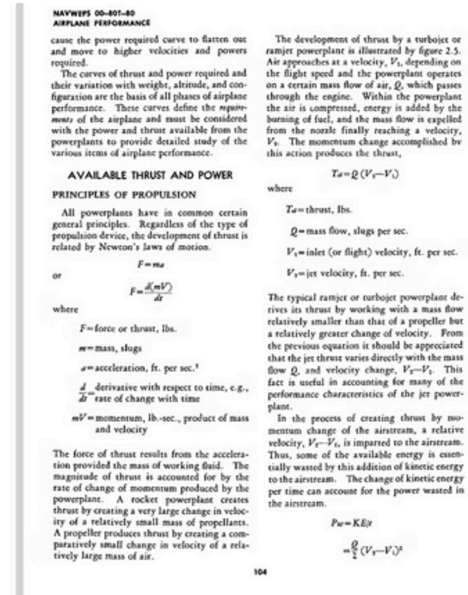

NAVWEPS 00-80T-80
AIRPLANE PERFORMANCE

cause the power required curve to flatten out and move to higher velocities and powers required.

The curves of thrust and power required and their variation with weight, altitude, and configuration are the basis of all phases of airplane performance. These curves define the *requirements* of the airplane and must be considered with the power and thrust available from the powerplants to provide detailed study of the various items of airplane performance.

AVAILABLE THRUST AND POWER

PRINCIPLES OF PROPULSION

All powerplants have in common certain general principles. Regardless of the type of propulsion device, the development of thrust is related by Newton's laws of motion.

$$F = ma$$

or

$$F = \frac{d(mV)}{dt}$$

where

F = force or thrust, lbs.

m = mass, slugs

a = acceleration, ft. per sec.²

$\frac{d}{dt}$ = derivative with respect to time, e.g., rate of change with time

mV = momentum, lb.-sec., product of mass and velocity

The force of thrust results from the acceleration provided the mass of working fluid. The magnitude of thrust is accounted for by the rate of change of momentum produced by the powerplant. A rocket powerplant creates thrust by creating a very large change in velocity of a relatively small mass of propellants. A propeller produces thrust by creating a comparatively small change in velocity of a relatively large mass of air.

The development of thrust by a turbojet or ramjet powerplant is illustrated by figure 2.5. Air approaches at a velocity, V_1, depending on the flight speed and the powerplant operates on a certain mass flow of air, Q, which passes through the engine. Within the powerplant the air is compressed, energy is added by the burning of fuel, and the mass flow is expelled from the nozzle finally reaching a velocity, V_2. The momentum change accomplished by this action produces the thrust,

$$T_a = Q(V_2 - V_1)$$

where

T_a = thrust, lbs.

Q = mass flow, slugs per sec.

V_1 = inlet (or flight) velocity, ft. per sec.

V_2 = jet velocity, ft. per sec.

The typical ramjet or turbojet powerplant derives its thrust by working with a mass flow relatively smaller than that of a propeller but a relatively greater change of velocity. From the previous equation it should be appreciated that the jet thrust varies directly with the mass flow Q, and velocity change, $V_2 - V_1$. This fact is useful in accounting for many of the performance characteristics of the jet powerplant.

In the process of creating thrust by momentum change of the airstream, a relative velocity, $V_2 - V_1$, is imparted to the airstream. Thus, some of the available energy is essentially wasted by this addition of kinetic energy to the airstream. The change of kinetic energy per time can account for the power wasted in the airstream.

$$P_w = KE/t$$

$$= \frac{Q}{2}(V_2 - V_1)^2$$

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The first aircraft you fly (a Cessna) has no hydraulics has no pneumatic system has no 'gear' system (that retracts or extends) and is relatively simple in construction. Eventually however you graduate to larger aircraft that DO have all these things:

- Electrical
- Hydraulic
- Pneumatic
- Chemical (for example for propulsion)

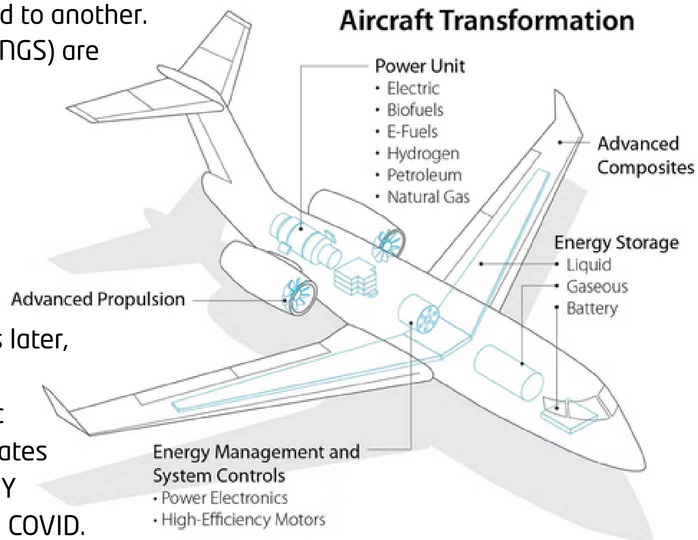
plus many other systems used to Aviate, Navigate, and Communicate in order to complete a flight safely

Fuel is ignited using STORED energy in a battery, in order to START a TURBINE generating HIGH-PRESSURE AIR - THEN used to START other turbines (aka ENGINES) which provide hydraulic, pneumatic, and electrical sources of energy...

1. to operate the landing gear, flaps, and other equipment
2. generate electrical power to lights, communications, and avionics
3. and provide thrust ultimately to convert chemical ENERGY to AIRSPEED or ALTITUDE.

continued

As a matter of fact... an aircraft is similar to a "big battery" wherein chemical, hydraulic, pneumatic, and electrical systems act interchangeably... one form of energy is stored and/or converted to another. Sophisticated airfoils (WINGS) are added and flight results.



Fast forward a few years later, my crew and I had just completed a transatlantic flight from the United States to the UK... flying a CRAZY amount of freight during COVID. Flights were all freight no passengers basically. It was the first time I really seriously started to think about money and finance, not because I was interested in stonks (I had ZERO interest in the stock market) but because I knew I couldn't save in dollars that lose value every year (somehow a remarkable number of Americans don't realize that... they think that prices are just supposed to go UP every year???)

My entire professional outlook, as a pilot at least, revolved around energy and the scarcity of fuel, range, and aircraft endurance... WHY would I save in paper money that could be created without energy OR scarcity?

In addition I saw growing up what unchecked power and centralization of control could do to people who were unpopular due to race, skin color or religion. It was something I experienced and witnessed, large groups of people who 'meant' well but did terrible things...

I read about it, studied it, history is replete with such examples... for example everyone 'knows' the history of the Soviet Union but few technologies can tie together Energy as well as Property Rights as well as Bitcoin in my opinion.

My crew and I landed in the UK in the morning, went to the hotel of course and we were exhausted. We agreed to rest up, meet up later on the way to a pub, enjoy a few drinks that night (UK beer is awesome) because we didn't leave till the following night.

I had never heard of Bitcoin, I didn't know anything about it, knew nothing of its history or price etc... I started from zero. But reading CNBC or the Wall Street Journal i figured (hoped lol) that I could understand "what was going on..." and what that had to do with money or finance. I can't save in pieces of paper so what else?

There was an article about Bitcoin (there were no ETFs at that time) and I thought... OK what is this Bitcoin thing? CNBC didn't explain much so I googled it.

Then read. And read some more, and more, and more...
I stayed up tired as I was, sat on the hotel room bed for NINE HOURS.
NINE HOURS STRAIGHT.
I was astounded. I had *no idea* anything like Bitcoin existed.

It's hard to convey to non-pilots the importance of fuel, aircraft range, and aircraft efficiency especially when flying long distances over water... You are trained to monitor and manage fuel consumption very carefully to always make sure you have enough. Not having enough fuel over water (for ANY contingency) is unacceptable.

And here was Bitcoin, a way of converting energy to Digital Capital, 'Digital Fuel' that could be stored, saved or transferred across the internet. How cool is this ****!!!

I was hooked immediately.

To this day, every time I make a Bitcoin transaction I think about that flight, about the relatively short history of Bitcoin and what it could become. Without energy and the ability to store it across our civilization, our planes trains and automobiles wouldn't work. Energy therefore is the great filter, with it you can climb or speed up, turn on the lights or provide pressurized air....

The storage and transfer of energy across civilization is fundamental to who we are and what we can accomplish.

I wanted to post this in 'flying' but there is no 'flying' category so I'm posting it in 'Bitcoin' instead... and with the uploaded files it 'costs' me 1000 Sats. Someone had to "mine" those sats, create heat, energy, and light in the process but its worth it.

Noone can 'take your sats' without your keys, and Sats cannot be created 'for free'. In that way they remind me so much of the airplane... energy can be converted from one form to another across our civilization... but it cannot be 'wished' into existence out of thin air something cannot 'come from nothing'.

One day our civilization will *also* reach that conclusion logically and fundamentally, and our civilization will run on Bitcoin. I pay these 1000 sats with pride and with appreciation for Stacker News.